was / were · the past simple · Did…?: side by side

Day 2 · Grammar beyond Murphy

Murphy first
Murphy red: Unit 11 (page 33): **11.5** and Unit 12 (page 35): **12.3** in class. At home: Unit 10 (page 31): **10.4** and Additional exercises **10, 11** (page 256).
This week there is no new grammar. This file puts the three past tenses side by side.

1 · Which verb: be or another verb?

be (was / were): where, how, what something is like → *I **was** at home. It **was** cold. They **were** tired.*
Other verbs: past simple → *I **stayed** at home. We **went** out.*
Never both: ✗ I ~~was went~~ home.

2 · Three question patterns

be: ***Was** it good? **Were** you late? Where **were** you?*
other verbs: ***Did** you go? What **did** you see?*
who / what = subject: *Who **called**? What **happened**?* (no did)

3 · Three negative patterns

be: *I **wasn't** there. They **weren't** ready.*
other verbs: *I **didn't go**. She **didn't see** it.* (didn't + base form)
there: *There **wasn't** a bank. There **weren't** any shops.*

4 · Time words for the past

yesterday · last night / week / year · two days ago · in 2019 · on Monday · at six o'clock · when I was a child
First… Then… After that… Suddenly… In the end… (story order)

5 · The 8 most common mistakes (Russian speakers)

✗ I ~~didn't went~~ → I didn't **go** ✗ Did you ~~saw~~…? → Did you **see**…? ✗ Where ~~did~~ you ~~were~~? → Where **were** you?
✗ I ~~was went~~ → I **went** ✗ Was cold yesterday → **It** was cold ✗ What ~~did happen~~? → What **happened**?
✗ ~~Yesterday I am~~ → Yesterday I **was** ✗ ~~In last year~~ → **Last** year

Practice

Day 2 · Practice 1

What to do: Exercises 1–2 in class, alone, then check. Exercise 3: the class translates aloud, one sentence each.

1 Find the mistake and correct the sentence

1. I didn’t went to school yesterday.
2. Where did you were last night?
3. Was cold on Sunday.
4. Did you saw the film?
5. What did happen at the party?
6. She was go to the library.
7. Yesterday I am at home.
8. We went there in last year.

2 Choose the correct form

1. Where (was / did) you go last summer?
2. We (were / did) not at home.
3. (Was / Did) the film good?
4. I (didn’t see / wasn’t see) him yesterday.
5. Who (called / did call) you?
6. There (wasn’t / didn’t) a bank near the hotel.
7. They (weren’t / didn’t) happy about the result.
8. What time (was / did) the lesson start?

3 Translate into English

1. Вчера я был дома.

2. Мы не ходили в библиотеку.

3. Где ты был вчера вечером?

4. Что случилось?

5. Ты видел это кино?

6. Было холодно, и никого не было.

7. Они приехали поздно и не ужинали.

Practice 2

Day 2 · Practice 2

What to do: Alone, then read your sentences aloud.

4 Look at the picture and write what happened



Write 6 sentences: positive, negative and one question. Use was / were, the past simple and didn't. *The robot was in the hall. The children didn't run away.*

5 Complete the story: was / were / past simple / didn't

Last Sunday I (1 be) _____ at my grandmother's house. It (2 be) _____ a warm day, and there (3 be) _____ a lot of flowers in the garden. We (4 not / stay) _____ inside. First we (5 play) _____ football, and then we (6 eat) _____ lunch. My cousin (7 not / like) _____ the soup, but I (8 love) _____ it. (9 you / ever / visit) _____ a village? (10 what / you / do) _____ there?

Answers · Day 2 grammar

For the teacher

1 I didn’t go to school yesterday. · Where were you last night? · It was cold on Sunday. · Did you see the film? · What happened at the party? · She went to the library. · Yesterday I was at home. · We went there last year.

2 did · were · Was · didn’t see · called · wasn’t · weren’t · did

3 Yesterday I was at home. · We didn’t go to the library. · Where were you last night? · What happened? · Did you see this film? · It was cold, and there was nobody there. · They arrived late and didn’t have dinner.

4 Own answers.

5 was · was · were · didn’t stay · played · ate · didn’t like · loved · Did you ever visit · What did you do